4th The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: October 2025. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at $68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

October 2025 Locked October 2025 is locked (closed 4 Nov 2025). These numbers won't change.

In short: Jobs made a 44.7% gross margin in October: maintenance contracts the most (63.8%), installations the least (34.1%).

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

October's jobs made $64,114 gross margin (44.7%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $31,056 and overheads $57,980, leaving ($24,922) profit before tax ((17.4%) of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 62.0% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$64,114
Technician wages and on-costs	$68,218
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$37,162
Technician time not charged to jobs	$31,056
Gross profit (the P&L)	$33,058
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$57,980
Profit before tax (the P&L)	($24,922)
Revenue	$143,566
Gross margin on jobs, %	44.7%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	(17.4%)
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**62.0%**

Type of job: All jobs

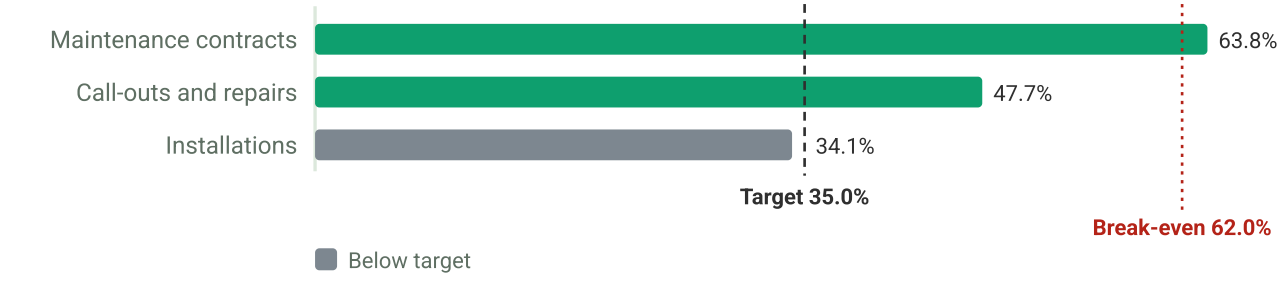
Job gross margin, October · All jobs
44.7%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, September · All jobs
44.0%
target 35.0%

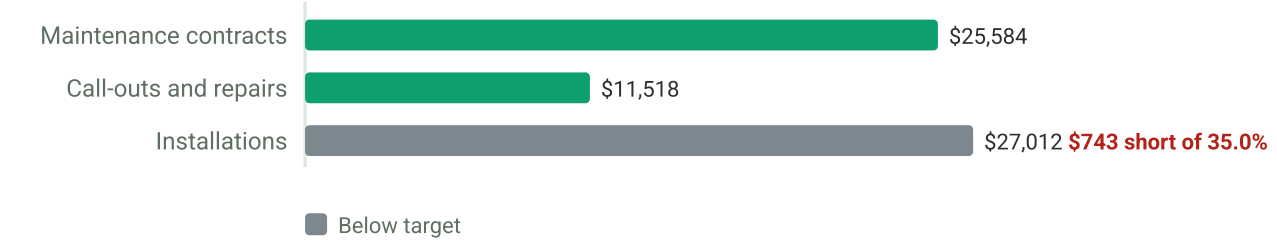
Gross margin jobs need to break even
62.0%
covers overheads and time not charged (October)

Job gross margin by type of job, October 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

In October maintenance contracts made a 63.8% job gross margin, installations made a 34.1% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 47.7% job gross margin (technician time at $68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 62.0% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 34.1% gross margin, 0.9 points under the 35.0% target: about $743 on $79,300 of revenue in October. It's below the 62.0% needed to cover overheads, too. Maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($11,549 ahead on $40,100 in October).

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

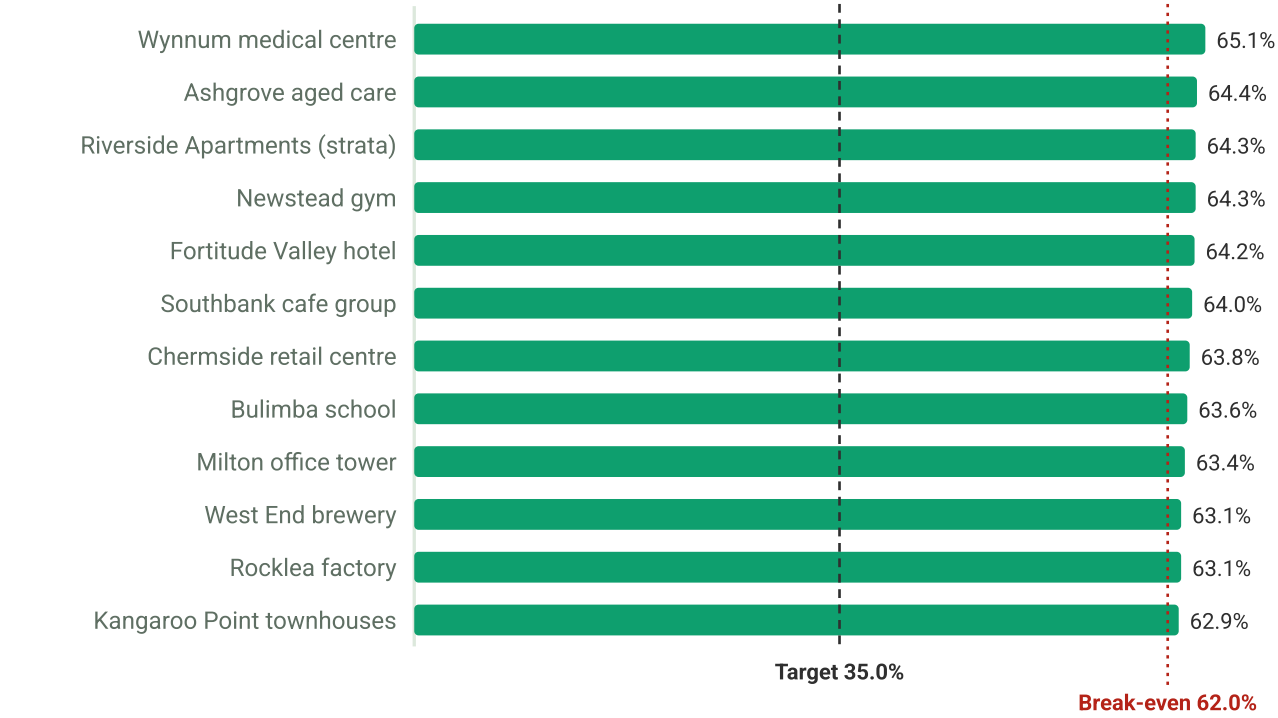
Job gross margin, October · Maintenance contracts
63.8%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, September · Maintenance contracts
63.9%
target 35.0%

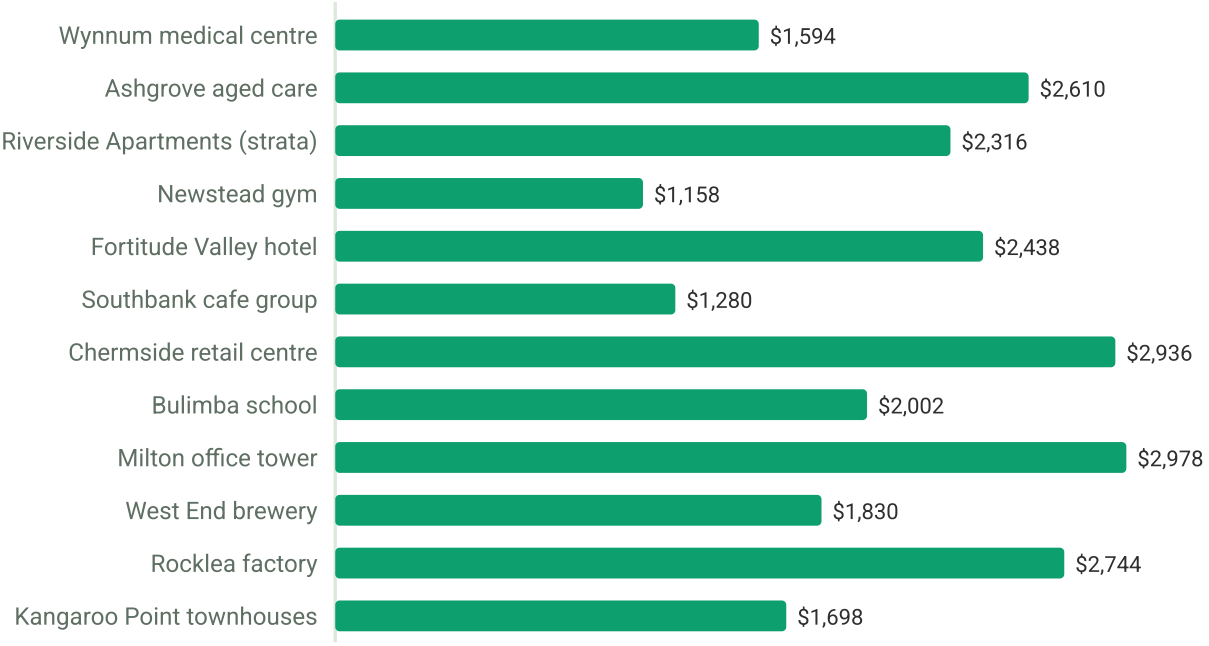
Gross margin jobs need to break even
62.0%
covers overheads and time not charged (October)

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, October 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

All 12 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 62.9% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a $2,700 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The thinnest, Kangaroo Point townhouses: 62.9% gross margin, 27.9 points over the 35.0% target ($753 ahead on $2,700 in October). All maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($11,549 ahead on $40,100 in October).

Type of job: Installations

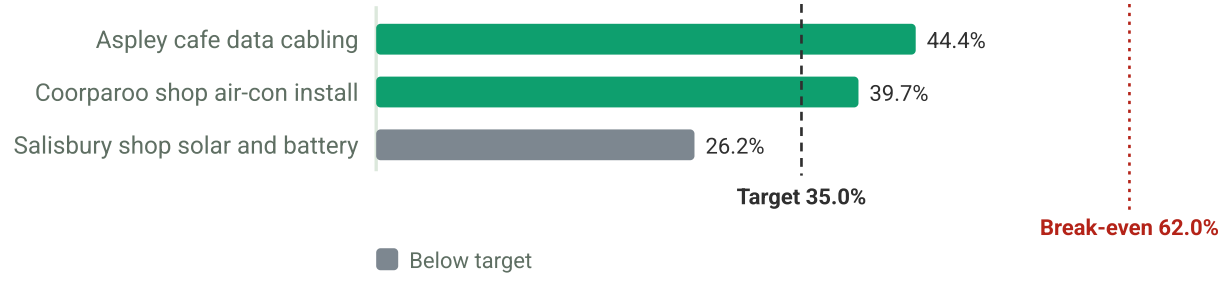
Job gross margin, October · Installations
34.1%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, September · Installations
34.2%
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even
62.0%
covers overheads and time not charged (October)

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in October 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

1 of the 3 installation jobs invoiced in October made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Salisbury shop solar and battery made a 26.2% job gross margin: 120.0 h of technician time ($8,160) and $3,900 of subcontractors on a $39,800 job. Jobs need 62.0% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

1 installation under the 35.0% target, worth about $3,490 between them on $39,800 of revenue. The biggest gap, Salisbury shop solar and battery: 26.2% gross margin, 8.8 points under the 35.0% target: about $3,490 on $39,800 of revenue in October. It's below the 62.0% needed to cover overheads, too.

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

Job gross margin, October · Call-outs and repairs
47.7%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, September · Call-outs and repairs
48.5%
target 35.0%

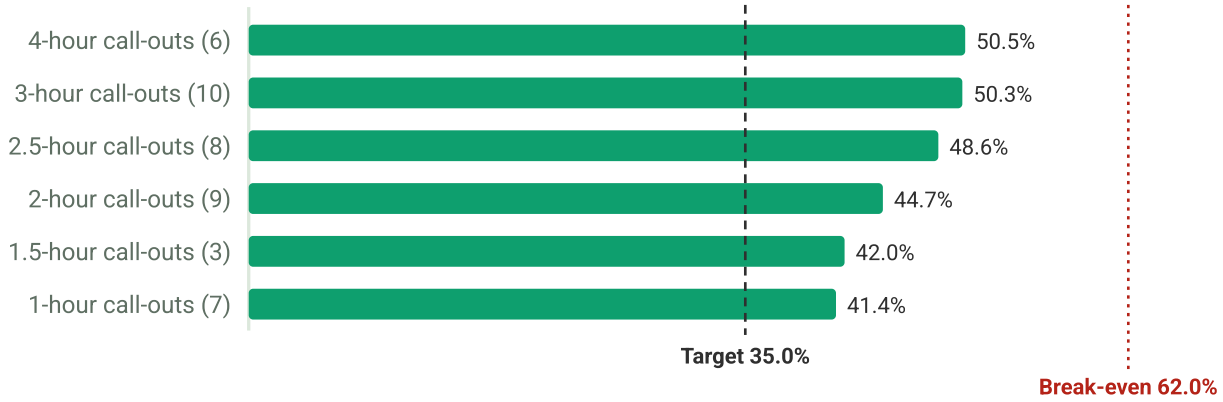
Gross margin jobs need to break even
62.0%
covers overheads and time not charged (October)

Technician time charged, October
$16,873
69.8% of call-out revenue

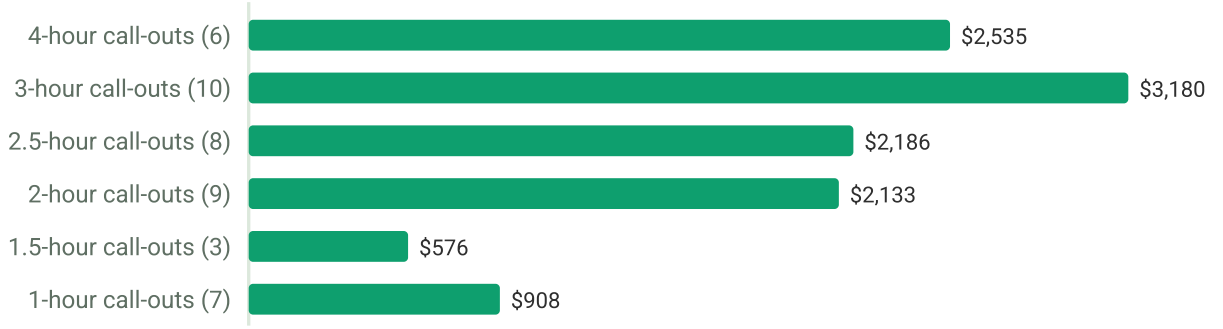
Materials charged, October
$7,293
$5,610 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, October 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

43 call-outs in October billed $16,873 of technician time and $7,293 of materials ($5,610 at cost plus 30%), and made a 47.7% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 41.4% to 50.5% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

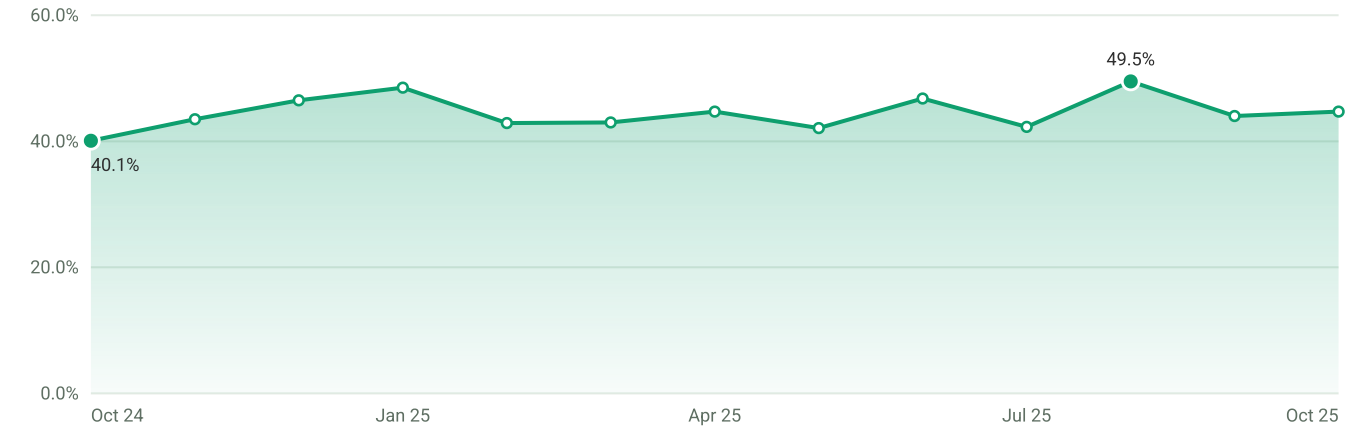
What you'd do about it

All call-outs: 47.7% gross margin, 12.7 points over the 35.0% target ($3,060 ahead on $24,166 in October).

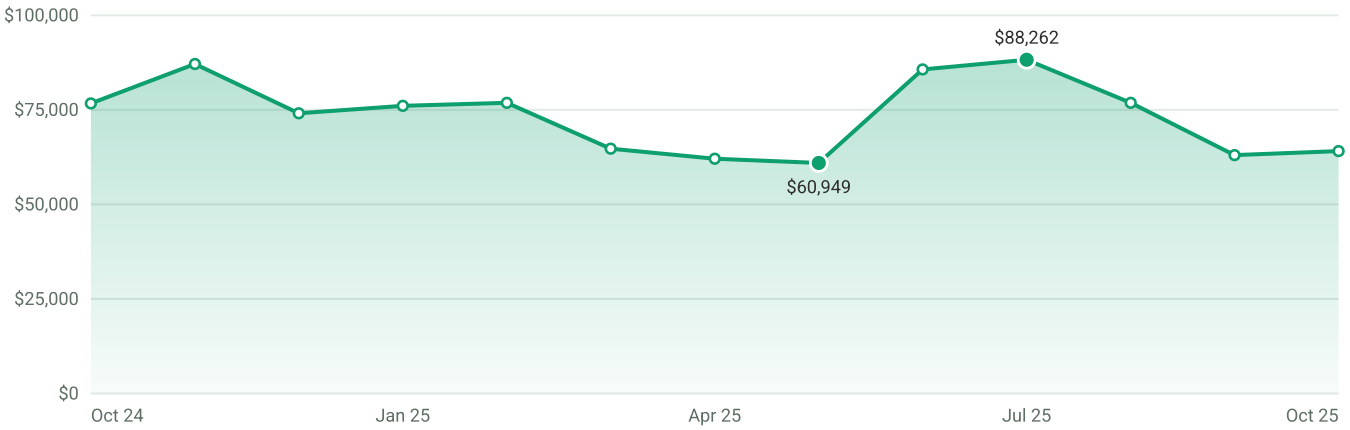
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin $



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.